

your subject appears. An editor uses a combination of the different perspectives from these shots to construct a scene which best captures the energy and intention of the scene. For example, in the movie *Gravity* the first 17 minutes of the movie take you into the story and throw you very quickly into the action packed drama of the story as action, catastrophe and drama strike the characters. These first 17 minutes are critical to storytelling so you as the audience completely believe the world of the story - floating in outer space above the Earth - and that is accomplished by keeping these 17 minutes within one continuous take. Its hard to notice that when watching the movie - the camera just floats around the characters and environment making you the audience an almost real presence in the world of the story - this decision exists on many levels but it is the job of the editor to establish whether it works like it is intended.



Another instance is when action scenes involving two characters fighting is portrayed. In the classic example of *Rocky* (number 1) as the two boxers fight in the climax scene the camera rapidly cuts between the punches and the reactions of the title character. The choice of which expression, which actor reaction shot, the movement of the camera around the characters and the cutaways to the audience are all part of the storytelling to establish the drama and significance

of the final scene. The fighter - Rocky - is getting beaten, we see the blood close up, the sweat, the pain in his face, then we see his worried girlfriend in the crowd and back to him walking back boldly to the opponent and we know he's a hero. That is the art of editing.

Once you start studying movies visually rather than just experiencing them passively, you will start noticing the choices an editor makes when constructing scenes. A great example for study is 2011 Academy Award Winning movie *The Artist* which uses only black and white silent acting shots with music to tell a truly emotional story. These shot choices are complemented by an assortment of other decisions like sound and effects. But at the core of it is the sequence of shots that are shown to the audience. That's where the story is told.